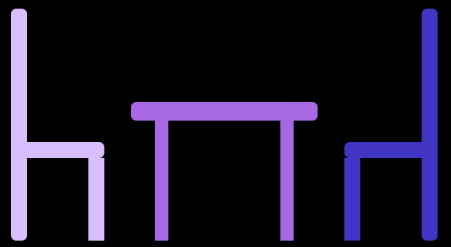
SIMPLY CYBERCON

You’re Doing This Whole AI Job Hunt Thing Wrong

Lessons from both sides of the hiring table

Mike Small | InfosecWizard



WHO AM I



Mike Small

About 10 years across SOC, incident response, malware analysis, pentesting and purple team

Lead penetration tester at a Fortune 100 company

Part owner, Tandem Cyber Solutions

Previously built out a global SOC on the management side

19+ certifications, including OSCP, OSEP, GXPN, GCIH and GCIA

WHY LISTEN TO ME

Two chairs, in 2025 to 2026

The coaching chair

I ran a community built around getting people hired in cybersecurity. Resume reviews, portfolio teardowns, a lot of conversations, technical walk throughs.

The hiring chair

At the same time I was building out a global SOC on the management side. I read the resumes and decided who made the cut.

The same gaps showed up over and over.

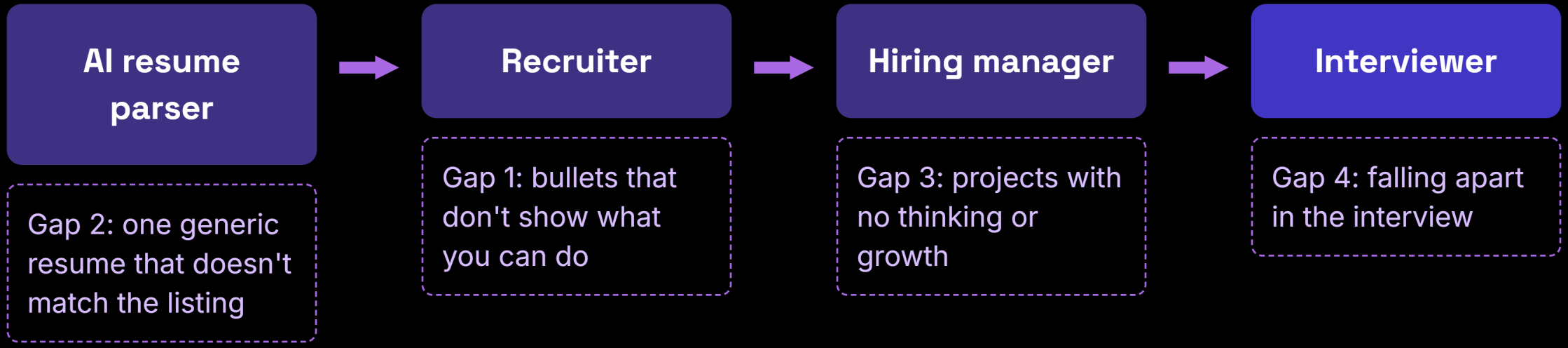
This is not a "paste your resume into ChatGPT and hope" talk.

If you can’t defend it in an interview, it doesn’t go on the page.

The one rule for everything that follows.

THE PIPELINE

How your resume actually gets read



GAP 1

Your bullets don’t show what you can do

What I kept seeing

- Reviewed firewall, WAF, endpoint, and authentication logs to detect suspicious activity.
- Monitored SIEM alerts and escalated incidents as needed.
- Performed vulnerability scans using Nessus.
- Assisted with incident response activities.
- Responsible for maintaining security tools.

GAP 1

Your bullets don’t show what you can do

The coaching chair

Bullets that describe the job instead of the work. Relevant experience left off entirely because the person didn't realize it counted.

The hiring chair

Nothing connects your past work to the role you applied for. The line reads the same as everyone else's in the stack.

GAP 2: ONE FLAT RESUME FOR EVERY ROLE

The summary

What I kept seeing

”Motivated, experienced SOC analyst passionate about protecting organizations and eager to grow my skills.”

GAP 2: ONE FLAT RESUME FOR EVERY ROLE

The skills section

Keywords with no evidence

SIEM | Splunk | Wireshark | Nmap | Python | Linux | Active Directory | MITRE ATT&CK | NIST | Incident Response | Threat Intel | Firewalls

Composite example

GAP 2: ONE FLAT RESUME FOR EVERY ROLE

The job history

IT Help Desk Technician

- Reset passwords and unlocked accounts
- Resolved tickets in the ticketing system
- Imaged and deployed laptops

Composite example

In coaching, a lot of people had done security work in their IT role. It just wasn't on the page.

GAP 2

One flat resume for every role

The coaching chair

One resume, sent to every job, unchanged from listing to listing.

The hiring chair

Nothing on it maps to my job description. It looks like they're applying for whatever's open.

GAP 3

Projects that don’t show thinking or growth

The write-up

```
Step 1: Opened Wireshark.
Step 2: Loaded the pcap.
Step 3: Filtered for HTTP.
Step 4: Found the flag.
```

The project list

- TryHackMe room walkthrough
- Python port scanner
- Home Pi-hole setup
- Wireshark CTF

GAP 3

Projects that don’t show thinking or growth

The coaching chair

Write-ups that read like copied-and-pasted lab steps. Nothing on what they learned, what failed, or where they'd take it next.

The hiring chair

Disjointed one-offs that don't build on each other, often unrelated to the job they're applying for.

GAP 4

You fall apart in the interview

On the resume

"Led incident response for a ransomware attack across the enterprise."

The interviewer

"Tell me about that ransomware incident. What was your first move?"

The candidate

"Well, uh... I was more supporting the team on that one. I mostly... watched how they handled it?"

GAP 4

You fall apart in the interview

The coaching chair

Resumes with claims the person couldn't explain when I asked about them.

The hiring chair

Once one claim falls apart in the interview, I start doubting everything else on the page.

Okay, I’m done roasting your resumes.

Let’s fix them.

FIX 1 | Gap 1: Your bullets don't show what you can do

The same work, written two ways

BEFORE

"Reviewed firewall, WAF, endpoint, and authentication logs to detect unauthorized access attempts and suspicious activity."

AFTER

"Investigated suspicious activity alerts by **pivoting on user, host and IP**, using authentication logs **to identify the account**, EDR **to determine what ran and which process created it**, and firewall logs **to trace outbound connections**."

Show how you think, not just what you touched.

Starter skill in the repo

Let AI interview you

1. Attach your resume and name the role you're targeting.
2. Let it ask what you did, why you did it, and what came next.
3. It documents everything you tell it. That's your **master list**, the facts every tailored resume gets written from.

Prompt

```
I'm targeting a SOC analyst role, and my current resume
is attached.

Interview me about each job on it, one question at a time,
until you've uncovered everything relevant. Ask what I did,
why I did it, and what I did next. Look for security work I
left off.

After each job, document what I did, why, what came next, the
tools, and my role. Don't write resume bullets yet. This is
my master list, and I'll tailor from it later. Use only facts
I gave you, and ask if something is unclear.
```

FIX 2 | Gap 2: One flat resume for every role

Starter skill in the repo

Master list in, tailored resume out



Example prompt Full starter skill in the repo

```
I'm applying for the attached job listing. My master list is also attached.

First, list each requirement in the listing and match it to experience from my master list, or mark it as a gap. Then ask me about each gap, one at a time, in case I've done something related.

Then build my resume for this listing. Leave a placeholder at the top that says [SUMMARY GOES HERE], and write the rest from the experience that best matches. Use only facts from my master list. If something important is missing, ask me instead of filling it in.

Finally, list the gaps still open so I know what to study.
```

Starter skill in the repo

What the AI is not allowed to do

No skills, tools or numbers that aren't in your master list.

Requirements you don't meet go on your study list, not your resume.

What a good summary does

The role The job you want, said plainly up front	"Help desk technician moving into SOC work.
The fit A specific link between what you've done and this role	The tickets I liked most were the ones nobody had an answer for yet, and digging until I found one is how I picked up most of what I know about Windows logs and Active Directory.
Who you'd be on the team Self-driven, always learning, shown in what you do	Right now I'm working through Security+ at night, building out a home lab to practice what I learn, and documenting every lab on GitHub. I like being the person the team can hand a weird problem to."

FIX 2 | Gap 2: One flat resume for every role

Starter skill in the repo

Then write the summary

Remember the three parts: **The role** **The fit** **Who you'd be on the team**

Example prompt Full starter skill in the repo

I'm applying for the attached job listing. The resume I built for it is also attached, with a placeholder where the summary goes.

Before writing anything, ask me a few questions, one at a time, about what I'm doing to learn and grow outside of work and what I'm like on a team. Ask for specific examples, not adjectives.

Then write a 3 to 4 sentence summary that does three things: states the role I'm targeting, shows why my experience fits this listing, and shows who I'd be on the team through what I actually do. Avoid filler like "motivated," "passionate" or "detail-oriented." Write it the way a person talks, not like a template.

Give me two versions so I can pick or combine them. **Use only facts from my resume and my answers. If something is unclear, ask.**

FIX 3 | Gap 3: Projects that don't show thinking or growth

Use AI to plan, build, write and publish

1

Plan your growth

Map what to learn next, and in what order, for the role you want.

2

Pick the project

Choose what to build next, or how to improve one you've already done.

3

Build and learn

Use it as a tutor. It explains and unblocks. You do the work.

4

Write it up

Get help with structure, but the voice and the lessons have to be yours.

5

Publish it

Build a project page, like GitHub Pages, that links to your repos.

Guardrail: you still have to understand everything you built. The interviewer will ask.

FIX 4 | Gap 4: You fall apart in the interview

Starter skill in the repo

Practice with an AI interviewer

1. Give it the job listing, your resume, and any study sheet from the recruiter.
2. It runs a full technical interview, one question at a time, including the claims on your resume.
3. You get every answer graded and a prioritized list of what to work on.

Example prompt Full starter skill in the repo

```
Run a technical interview for the attached job listing. My resume and any prep material are also attached.

Ask 10 to 15 questions, one at a time: my resume, realistic scenarios, then concepts and tools. Follow up on vague answers. No feedback until the end.

Then grade each answer Clear, Partly clear, or Needs work, and give me a prioritized list of what to work on, including resume lines I couldn't back up. Base example answers only on facts I gave you.
```

The test: anything you stumble on gets fixed or cut.

TAKE THESE WITH YOU

Starter skills in the repo

Career interviewer
Interviews you about each job and documents your master list

Resume tailoring
Builds a resume for one listing from your master list

Professional summary
Writes your summary after a short interview about you

Cover letter
Writes a short, specific letter from your master list

Job application
Runs resume, summary, and cover letter in order

Interview practice
Mock technical interview with graded feedback

github.com/infosecwizardry/ai-job-hunt-toolkit

Each one as a Claude skill and a copy-paste prompt

Nothing replaces who you are.

Use AI to be impossible to miss.

Mike Small | InfosecWizard

Get the toolkit

github.com/infosecwizardry/ai-job-hunt-toolkit

Watch on YouTube

youtube.com/@InfosecWizard

Join the Discord

discord.gg/XjHJFp4KSm

Connect on LinkedIn

linkedin.com/in/michealsmall